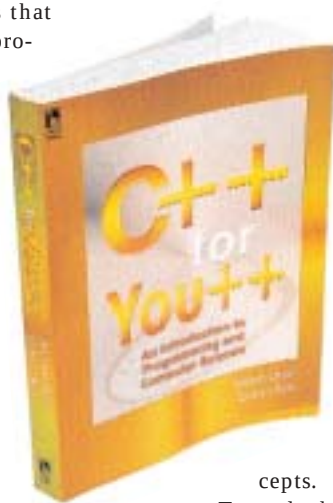




C++ for You++

Enchiridion of C++ Programming

There are way too many books that offer an introduction to C++ programming. What sets *C++ for You++* apart is that it doesn't give long essays describing simple concepts, or bamboozle you with advanced explanations. In this dichotomous book, the first section contains the explanation of C++ programming, and the second explains implementation details, such as classes and data structures. The book starts off with an introduction to computers in general, touching briefly upon both hardware and software. The second chapter introduces a C++ program containing all the basic elements such as Pre-processor, loops, library functions, etc. From here, all the concepts are explained



in detail, in separate chapters. There is an exercise with answers provided at the end of each chapter.

The second section starts with a chapters on linked list, stacks, queues, etc, and proceeds to explain the related concepts.

Towards the end, the authors deal with algorithms, starting with the analysis of algorithms and finishing off

with chapters on searching, hashing and sorting. A sore point of the book is the numbering of the pages. Each page is numbered as XXX-DD, where XXX is the abbreviation of the chapter name and DD gives the page number within that chapter—This makes it difficult to reach to a specific page directly.

This book is definitely not recommended for those who are already fluent in C and want to learn C++. Concepts such as Object Oriented Programming and related concepts are treated very lightly in the Chapter 22. Also, the book places more emphasis on practical implementation, rather than the theoretical aspects of programming. The book is aimed at those who want to start off by learning C++, and it serves this purpose pretty well.

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Rating: ★★★★★



Red Hat Linux 9 for Dummies

You would not be a dummy after reading this!

Aimed at beginners, this series has long been popular. This book is also in line with this trend, and is for Windows users who want to switch to Linux, and don't know much about it. It talks about installing as well as using it at home—and yes, it covers networking too.

Divided into six parts and 19 chapters, the first part deals with installing Red Hat Linux 9 and details everything—right from partitioning to post-install configuration. The second, comprising four

chapters, helps you set up the Internet and tells how to configure the dial-up modem, broadband connections, the LAN and the firewall. The next part is about running various applications on the GNOME desktop environment. It tells you how to play songs, video and even burn CDs. There is also a chapter that introduces you to OpenOffice, the counter part of MS Office for Linux. The only conspicuous by its absence are words on the KDE desktop.

From this point onward, the book is no

more for dummies. It talks about the nitty gritty of setting up a network and maintaining it for over 80 pages. Solutions to common Linux issues are discussed in the penultimate part of the book. The Appendices talk about advanced topics such as using the Red Hat Package Manager.

The book does a good job of realising the issues with Linux, and clearly highlights the problems you will encounter and their workarounds. It also lists out security vulnerabilities in Linux, and follows the regular traditions of the Dummies series and notifies you of tips, warnings and facts. This makes the information easy to digest.

All in all, the book makes for an entertaining and informative must-read for a newbie.



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